Northwind Labs Employee Handbook

1. Working hours

The standard working week is 37.5 hours, Monday to Friday. Core hours are 10:00 to 15:00. Outside core hours you may start any time between 7:00 and 10:00.

2. Remote work

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week. Northwind pays a home-office budget of ?600 once every three years for a desk, chair or monitor.

3. Annual leave

Full-time staff receive 28 days of paid annual leave plus public holidays. Up to five unused days carry over to the next year and must be taken before 31 March.

4. Sick leave

If you are ill, notify your manager before 9:30 on the first day. A doctor's note is required from the fourth consecutive day of absence.

5. Parental leave

Primary caregivers receive 20 weeks of fully paid parental leave. Secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks of fully paid leave, to be taken within the child's first year.

6. Travel and expenses

Book economy for flights under six hours; business class requires director approval. Submit expense claims within 30 days of the purchase, with receipts attached.

7. Learning budget

Every employee has a learning budget of ?1,500 per year for courses, books and conferences, plus 5 paid study days.

8. Equipment and security

Laptops are replaced every three years. Report a lost or stolen device to security@northwind.example within 24 hours so it can be wiped remotely.

9. Probation and notice

New hires have a probation period of six months, with a notice period of two weeks. After probation the notice period is one month for both sides.

10. Gifts and hospitality

Gifts from suppliers or customers worth more than ?50 must be declared to the compliance team within one week.